Buncrana Parish Newsletter

ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last weekend's collection totalled €6,390
The total amount collected for this year's Trócaire Appeal amounted to €11, 930.
Sincere thanks.

Anniversary Masses & Times

ST MARY'S ORATORY
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana
Monday 11 May - Mass at 10am
John McLaughlin (50th A)
Tuesday 12 May - Mass at 10am
Thanksgiving Mass
Wednesday 13 May - Mass at 10am
Thursday 14 May - Mass at 10am
Deceased Members of The McLaughlin and Martin Families
Saturday 16 May - Mass at 4:30pm
Ann Coyle
Sunday 17 May - Mass at 8:30am
Sunday 17 May - Mass at 12:30pm
Mary Price

ST. MARY'S, COCKHILL
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill
Friday 15 May - Mass at 7pm
Josephine McGonagle (MM),
Sean McHugh (5th A),
Johnny and Margaret Gallagher, plus
Declan Mulholland (6th A)
Sunday 17 May - Mass at 11am
Deirdre Kelly (21st A)

STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY
Masses streamed on
www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish
Sunday 17 May - Mass at 9:45am

DEATHS
Your prayers are asked for
Dermot (Danny) Sullivan
who died recently and for his
family & friends saddened by their loss.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS
In our first reading this weekend we hear about the people of Samaria receiving the Holy Spirit. As we approach Pentecost we pray for a fresh and powerful outpouring of the Holy Spirit on the Church, on the world, on our country, on our parish communities, and on each one of us. May the Spirit fill the hearts and minds of deacons, seminarians, and all those discerning a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, and may many more hear and follow the call to serve the Church as priests.

MAY ROSARY
The Rosary will be prayed at both the Oratory and Cockhill Grottos at 8pm each evening during the month of May. The Rosary will be offered for World Peace. Please come and join us during the month of May.

ALL IRELAND ROSARY RALLY
A local bus is being organised to Knock for the All-Ireland Rosary Rally on Sat 6 June. Contact Mary on 0861268123 to book or for further information.

Priest on Call 074 9361253

Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com
Website: www.buncranaparish.com
Sixth Sunday of Easter
10 May 2026

SAVE THE DATE
FATHER BRADLEY'S 30TH ANNIVERSARY 2026
Father Bradley marks thirty years as a priest this year. He was one of the three priests ordained in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, in 1996. Particularly because it was not possible to celebrate his Silver Anniversary in 2021 when we were under Covid lockdown, the parishes will mark this moment on Sunday 28 June 2026 with Mass at 3pm in St Mary's Church, Cockhill, in the presence of Bishop McKeown, followed by a gathering in the Inishowen Gateway Hotel. All will be welcome.

FIRST HOLY COMMUNION 2026
Sat 16 May at 11am in St Mary's Oratory:
Scoil Íosagáin
Sat 23 May at 11am in Star of the Sea, Desertegney:
St Egney's NS
Sat 23 May at 1:30pm in St Mary's, Cockhill:
Gaelscoil Bhun Cranncha.
Sat 30 May at 11am in St Mary's, Cockhill:
St Oran's NS, Scoil N Iosáf, Illies &
Scoil N Pádraig, Drumfries
Please keep all the children in your prayers at this time.

READINGS FOR 6TH SUNDAY OF EASTER
1st Reading Acts 8:5-8, 14-17. After Stephen was stoned to death a severe persecution had scattered the disciples. Philip the deacon went to Samaria where his preaching and miracles brought many to baptism. The Church in Jerusalem sent Peter and John to confirm the converts in the Holy Spirit.
2nd Reading 1 Pet 3:15-18. Targets for calumny and persecution, Christians must defend themselves with the weapons of Christ, i.e., uprightness of life, courtesy and respect.
Gospel Jn 14:15-21. Jesus' affectionate farewell to the Apostles continues. He will not leave his disciples orphans. Having loved him, they will keep God's commandments. The Father and Jesus will send the 'paraclete', who will remain with them forever. 'Paraclete' translates: 'advocate, intercessor, counsellor, protector, support.'

SILENT RETREAT
Theme: "If you but knew the gift of God." Preached by: Fr. Kilian Byrne, Foyer of Charity. Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry, 13 to 19 July. Cost: £395/ €450 Full Board. Contact: Helen : 00353 86 1678027 / hellywilliams@gmail.com or www.foyerofcharity.ie A privileged time to come away from noise and listen to the Spirit of God, - Who is Love. Silence, prayer, teachings & liturgy of the Church.

KNOCK PILGRIMAGE TO PRAY FOR PEACE IN THE HOLY LAND
People from all over are invited to Knock Shrine on Sat 16 May, for a special pilgrimage to pray for peace in the Holy Land. The pilgrimage – organised by the papal charity Aid to the Church in Need – will be led by Bishop William Shomali from Bethlehem who will offer a message of hope at 11am, and celebrate Mass at 3pm. All welcome. More info at www.acnireland.org

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Walsh 9361393
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9361253
Parish Catechist 086 785 3726

ADORATION CHAPEL
Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel
Sunday 2pm - 10pm
Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm
Friday 6am - 10pm

GUIDED HOLY HOUR
The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary's Oratory. All Welcome.

FATIMA STATUE
The Statue of Our Lady of Fatima is available for any person/family to have in their home for a week. Please contact Mary on 0860501418 to book or for further info.

CATHOLIC SCHOOL LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES
The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre, working in Partnership with Saint Mary's University, Twickenham, offers a number of avenues for the professional development and spiritual formation of Catholic school leaders. The Full Masters in Catholic School Leadership is a post graduate degree dedicated to the professional development and spiritual formation of Catholic school leaders. A Post Graduate Certificate and Diploma are also offered. These avenues are a great opportunity for those currently in leadership roles and those who aspire to, or have an interest in, leadership roles within the Catholic School system. If you are interested in registering for any options in Sept 2026, attending an online information session on Mon 8 June @4pm, or require any further information, please contact the Catechetical Centre on 004428 71264087 or tferry@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESE OF DERRY
LOUGH DERG PILGRIMAGE 2026
The Diocese of Derry Three-Day Pilgrimage to Lough Derg will take place from Fri 24 July to Sun 26 July 2026. Lough Derg continues to welcome people seeking prayer, peace, reflection and renewal in the midst of busy lives. A bus will travel from St Eugene's Cathedral, via Strabane and Lifford. Cost: £95 / €110 including bus transport. You are welcome, of course, to use your own means of transport. Booking form and full details available at: derrydiocese/lough-derg

LADIES' RETREAT
The Sisters from the Apostles of the Sacred Heart of Jesus based in Waterford will lead a ladies weekend retreat in the Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, entitled 'In the Upper Room with Mary', from Fri 22 - Sun 24 May. The cost incl. accommodation is £90. For booking / info call Aoife on 04871262512 or termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

PARISH DRAW

Friday 1 May: Week 47
1st Prize: €500
Denise Cunningham, c/o Scoil Iósagáin
Promoter: Susan Fletcher
2nd Prize: €300
Tessie Doherty, Kinnego
Promoter: Tessie Doherty
3rd Prize: €150
Tommy Burns, Milltown
Promoter: Catherine Burns

KNOW YOUR EIRCODE – IT MATTERS On behalf of Buncrana First Responders: In our community, safety and coordination depend on clear communication. One of the simplest yet most important things you can do is make sure you know your Eircode. Your Eircode is essential for identifying your location quickly and accurately, especially in situations where time matters. Whether it's for routine coordination or an emergency, having your Eircode at your fingertips can make all the difference. Take a moment today to learn it, save it, and share it with those around you. A small step like this helps keep everyone informed, connected, and safe. **Stay aware. Stay prepared. Know your Eircode.**
MEDJUGORJE PILGRIMAGES 2026 (45th Anniversary): 7 nights June 24th - July 1st. Depart Dublin - Mostar. Return Split - Dublin. €855 pp sharing. Single room supplement €170. For more information please contact Ursula O Faodhagain, Castlefin 0872960562
BUNCRANA COMMUNITY LIBRARY as part of Bealtaine Festival 2026: ***Tue 12th May 11am*** The Swish of the Skirt & The Click of the Skivers - Book online or call (074) 917 5384. ***Fri 15th May 11.30am*** Hello, How Are You? Day - No need to book, just pop in.
LOURDES 2026 Special Offer: Pilgrimage to Lourdes from 3rd until 8th July, 2026. Flights from Derry and full board £899. Contact Maria at 04881648357 or WhatsApp +44 7768395038
ICARE AGM will be held on Tues 26th May at 7pm @ iCARE Centre, Looking Glass Brae, Ballymacarry, Buncrana F93XY61. Everyone welcome.
FREE 4-WEEK "MANAGE MY HOME" COURSE A free 4-week *Manage My Home* course will take place at the FET Centre in Buncrana, starting Thurs 14 May, from 10 am–12 pm. The course covers practical topics such as budgeting, energy saving, and more. All are welcome. For further info, please contact Claire on 086 174 0684.
LIFELINE INISHOWEN Domestic Violence Support Services have free counselling sessions available for Women & Children, We also offer support, drop-in and outreach services. Please contact us on our HELPLINE 074 9373232 or 086 00650353 between 10am and 1.30pm.

BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com

Trad
15A | 90mins
Saturday 9th & Sunday 10th May - 8.15pm
Monday 11th - Thursday 14th - 8.15pm

COMING NEXT WEEK
The Devil Wears Prada 2
15th - 21st May

BINGO

St Mary's Hall
Fridays at 8pm
Single book €11
Double €17
Snowball: €4350

Community Corner

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE **Drumfries Walking Group** (The Walkie Talkies) will be meeting on Friday 15 May at Ballyliffin car park, at 10am everyone welcome.
Fakeaway Cooking Class beginning Wednesday 13 May from 7-9pm at a cost of €60pp, places still available contact the centre on 0749361742.
THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Is your child between 3-12 years of age and you need help with their behaviour? Contact Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst at the Child Behaviour Consultancy to get advice regarding listening and following instruction, accepting 'No', and help with general behaviour. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa's Room.
AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else's drinking) meet in St Teresa's Room on Thurs at 6:45pm.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa's Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329.
THE PLAZA *Mon* Beginners Line Dancing 7.30-8.30pm. *Tues* Morning Line Dancing at 10.30am. *Wed* Line Dancing Class at 7.30pm. *Thurs* **Line Dancing Class in Burt Hall** 7.45pm €7 per class. **Line Dancing and Jiving Class in Laurentic Bar** Thurs 7:30pm. Hall available for hire & for children's birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317
INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173.
BEGINNER HATHA YOGA CLASS starting Monday 20th April at 7pm in Anglers Centre. Contact Anne Nelson 086 2586864 for more information.
DANCE FITNESS CLASS Every Tuesday 7-8pm in St Mary's Hall, Buncrana. All welcome to this full body workout to music.
NOWDOC Phone Number: 0818400911
SAMARITANS Call Free **116 123,** Text **087 2609090.**
RACHEL'S VINEYARD Have you been affected or hurt by abortion? Please contact Michelle on 00447871765181
DOG FREE ZONE A reminder that dogs are not permitted in Cockhill or Desertegney graveyards. Thank you.

A THOUGHT...
My wallet is like an onion - opening it makes me cry!

SLIMMING WORLD **Buncrana**: **The Exchange** every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall** every Thurs at 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Newtowncunningham: The Orange Hall** every Wed at 6.30pm with Ann Marie 0860848705.
GET THE GRADE English Tuition. Friendly, exam-focused, Junior & Leaving Cert tuition with experienced teacher of English & SEC Examiner (Teaching Council and Garda vetted). Text/Call Mark 0866655334
INISHOWEN INJURY CLINIC Treatment of back, neck and shoulder pain / sports injuries / rehabilitation. Contact Cahir McLaughlin NMT, Maginn Ave 0860753296
HEALTH & WELLBEING PARK RUN Come and join our community of walkers, runners and volunteers every Sat at 9.15am by the shore front play park. All welcome
GENTLE EXERCISE CLASS for people living with Parkinson's every Wed at 2pm in The Exchange.
COCKHILL CEILI CLUB Classes in Cockhill School Hall on Thurs from 8pm-9:30pm. Beginners welcome.
CEILI in Illies National School Fri 15 May 8pm -11pm. Music by Raymond Looney. Adm €10 incl supper and raffle. All welcome.
BUNCRANA PARENT AND TODDLERS GROUP in St Mary's Hall on Wed and Thur 10am-12noon.
SCOIL NAOMH IÓSAF **The Illies: F93 HX30 NOW ENROLLING for Sept 2026**. Forms are available on request by contacting the school: **Tel:** 9362212 **Email:** stjoesias@gmail.com
GAELSCOIL BHUN CRANNCHA Give us a call on 074 9361988 or an email at gsbc1999@gmail.com to discuss how an Irish medium education can benefit your child. If you don't speak Irish, don't worry. That won't hold your child back.
SWILLY GARDENING CLUB Our next Meeting of 2026 will take place on Mon 18 May at 8pm in the Buncrana Youth club (Boy's Club). Guest Speaker is Pauline Bryce Johnson from the Co-Op Garden Centre, Buncrana, who will give a talk from growing vegetables, sowing seeds and planting up summer pots. There will be a raffle on the night with a chance to win some plants. New Members welcome. Any queries contact Anne by text on 087 9560134.
ANAM CARA is hosting a support evening for Bereaved Parents on Thurs 14 May in the Inishowen Gateway Hotel from 7:30pm-9pm.
THE NET MAGAZINE The April edition of 'The Net' is available in print in parishes as well as on the Diocesan website.

PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary's Oratory and St Mary's Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary's Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary's Cockhill.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Síochána,** Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 00353 749102233 **ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108**